

Paige Turner

Your grievance with Grant

You were preparing a major investigation into Grant's collection and labor empire. He discovered enough to threaten an injunction and promised to reveal the identity of one of your confidential museum sources if you published.

Your other secret

You obtained internal documents through a source inside the Meridian. Protecting that source matters more to you than tonight's scoop.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Find out whether Grant found the full provenance spreadsheet or only excerpts.
3. Keep your source's identity protected.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant threatened to bury my investigation and ruin my access to sources. I had the documents for a story scheduled tonight. I wanted him answering questions, not dead.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I was at the Press Room scanner from 6:40 to 6:49, dealing with source documents behind my embargoed story. The museum attendant there watched me throughout. I did not go back to the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

From 6:40 to 6:49, I was at the Press Room scanner. I was dealing with source documents behind my embargoed story. I did not return to the Donor Salon during that time.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card A; animal CALLED = Card B. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The signed record confirms the attendant watched me at the Press Room scanner throughout the whole window. It also exposes source documents behind my embargoed story. I would rather be embarrassed than accused of murder.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

I stand by my account of being at the Press Room scanner. I dispute the service attendant's identification. I cannot produce a continuous alibi record. Please compare the time on that note with the poison window before deciding.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.